WP-6R-01: Paracetamol on the renal ward

Example General Hospital, Ward 6R. Version 3 (fictional). Owner: Ward 6R nurse in charge (fictional role).

FICTIONAL TRAINING DOCUMENT. Not clinical guidance. Example General Hospital is fictional.

Scope

Adult inpatients on Ward 6R (renal) who are prescribed paracetamol by mouth or by intravenous infusion.

Dose limits on Ward 6R

Ward 6R local rule: the maximum for every adult on this ward is 3 g in 24 hours, whatever the patient's weight.

Adults weighing less than 50 kg: 15 mg/kg per dose, and never more than 3 g in 24 hours.

The minimum interval between doses is 6 hours on Ward 6R.

Before every dose

- Check every source of paracetamol in the last 24 hours, including doses given during dialysis.
- Confirm the patient's current weight in MedTrack. Do not estimate it.

When to escalate

A 24-hour total above 3 g: stop all paracetamol and request an urgent medical review.